

IN THE HIGH COURT OF PUNJAB & HARYANA AT CHANDIGARH

2026:PHHC:086980



(204)

CRM-M-31857-2026 (O&M)

Date of Decision: 08.06.2026

Manpreet Singh @ Mani Ghnda

.....PETITIONER

Versus

The State of Punjab

.....RESPONDENT

CORAM: HON'BLE MS. JUSTICE NEERJA K. KALSON

Present: Mr. Mudit Johar, Advocate
for the petitioner.

Mr. Adhiraj Singh, AAG, Punjab.

NEERJA K. KALSON, J. (ORAL)

1. The present petition has been filed under Section 482 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 seeking concession of anticipatory bail in FIR No. 30 dated 18.02.2026 registered under Sections 311 & 310 (2) of the BNS, 2023 (corresponding Sections 397 and 395 IPC), registered at Police Station Ajitwal, District Moga.
2. Learned counsel for the petitioner contends that no specific role, attribution or overt act has been assigned to the petitioner in the FIR and that the allegations levelled against him are vague and omnibus in nature. It is further submitted that there is a delay of two days in lodging the FIR, which casts doubt on the prosecution case. Learned counsel submits that the petitioner is innocent, is ready and willing to join the investigation, and there is no likelihood of his absconding, influencing witnesses or tampering with the evidence. Therefore, the petitioner deserves to be granted the concession of anticipatory bail.

3. Per contra, learned State counsel opposes the petition and submits that the allegations against the petitioner are serious in nature. It is contended that the petitioner, along with his co-accused, intercepted the complainant during the night hours and, by brandishing a sharp-edged weapon, snatched two mobile phones, cash amounting to ₹2,500, and the complainant's Aadhaar Card. Learned State counsel further submits that the petitioner has been specifically named by the complainant in his statement and his involvement also finds mention in the disclosure statement of co-accused Ranjit Singh @ Gora. It is further submitted that two accused persons have already been arrested, while the arrest of the petitioner and two other co-accused is yet to be effected and the investigation is still in progress. Learned State counsel contends that the petitioner is a habitual offender and is involved in four other criminal cases besides the present one. It is further argued that the recovery of the snatched articles is yet to be effected and the involvement of the remaining co-accused persons is still under investigation. Therefore, custodial interrogation of the petitioner is necessary for effective investigation, recovery of the snatched articles and unearthing the complete chain of events. On these grounds, it is prayed that the petitioner does not deserve the concession of anticipatory bail at this stage.

4. Heard learned counsel for the parties.

5. The scope of consideration in a petition for anticipatory bail is limited to examining whether, on the basis of the material available, the petitioner has made out a case for grant of the extraordinary relief of pre-arrest bail. At this stage, the Court is not required to undertake a detailed appreciation of evidence or record findings on the merits of the allegations.

6. The allegations in the present case pertain to the commission of a robbery/snatching offence wherein the petitioner has been specifically named by the complainant and his involvement also finds mention in the disclosure statement of a co-accused. The material placed before the Court prima facie indicates the petitioner's participation in the occurrence under investigation.
7. Offences involving robbery and snatching are not merely offences against an individual victim but are offences against society at large, having a direct bearing on public order and the sense of security of citizens. Such offences, by their very nature, are required to be viewed seriously, particularly when the investigation is still in progress and the complete circumstances surrounding the occurrence are yet to be unearthed.
8. The investigating agency has stated that the recovery of the snatched articles is yet to be effected and that further investigation is required with regard to the role of the petitioner and other persons involved in the occurrence. In the facts and circumstances of the present case, this Court is satisfied that custodial interrogation of the petitioner cannot be said to be unwarranted at this stage.
9. Having regard to the nature and gravity of the allegations, the stage of investigation and the material collected so far, this Court finds no exceptional circumstance warranting the grant of the extraordinary relief of anticipatory bail. Consequently, the present petition is dismissed.
10. Pending application(s), if any, shall also stand disposed of.

(NEERJA K. KALSON)
JUDGE

08.06.2026
Atul

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| 1. | Whether speaking/reasoned | Yes/No |
| 2. | Whether reportable | Yes/No |